

Secondary 3 Subject Combination

30 July 2026



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Changes in education landscape with FSBB

Then ...	Moving ahead	Remarks
Changes in subjects		
Express / Normal Academic / Normal Technical Art / D&T / FCE	Lower Sec: Common Curriculum (CMN) subjects Upper Sec: G1/G2/G3 coursework options based on CMN performance at Lower Sec	
Normal Technical Social Studies	G1 Humanities (Social Studies, Humanities Exposure Modules)	G1 Humanities remain non-examinable and compulsory for 4 years
Express Mother Tongue B	MTL B -> G1 MTL Higher MTL -> G3 HMTL	



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Changes in education landscape with FSBB

Changes in cut-off points for JC and Polytechnic

Junior College	Now: $L1R5 \leq 20^*$ New: $L1R4 \leq 16^*$
Polytechnic	Now: $ELR2B2 \leq 26^{\wedge}$ (5 Express subjects) New: $ELR2B2 \leq 22^{\wedge}$ (4G3 + 1 G2)

* Raw score, before deduction of any bonus points

$\wedge$ Net score, after deduction of any bonus points



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Then ...	Moving ahead	Remarks
Changes in the National Examination		
GCE N-Level (Sept), GCE O-Level (Oct)	SEC (Singapore-Cambridge Secondary Education Certificate) – All students from G1/G2/G3 will sit for the national examination at the same time	English and Mother Tongue Language: Held in September All other subjects: October - November Release of results: One common results release in January
Mid-year GCE O-Level MTL Examination	Removal of MYE MTL examination, all papers will be taken during SEC	



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Then ...	Moving ahead	Remarks
Changes in the Post Secondary Education		
Admission Exercise to tertiary institution or JC - JAE (Joint Admission Exercise) O Level (Jan) - JIE (Joint Intake Exercise) N Level (Dec) - PFP AE (Polytechnic Foundation Programme Admission Exercise)		



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Changes in education landscape with FSBB

Students taking at least	POST-SEC PATHWAYS							
	3-Year Higher Nitec	2-Year Higher Nitec	NAFA Foundation Programme (NFP)	Arts Institutions	Polytechnic Foundation Programme (PFP)	Polytechnic Year 1	Millennia Institute	Junior College
5 G3 subjects	✓	✓	NEW ✓	✓	NEW ✓	✓	✓	NEW ✓
4 G3 + 1 G2 subjects	✓	✓	NEW ✓	NEW ✓	NEW ✓	NEW ✓		
5 G2 subjects	✓	✓	✓		✓			
4 G1 subjects	✓	NEW* ✓						



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Changes in education landscape with FSBB

At least	DSA-JC	Poly-EAE	ITE-EAE
6 or 5 G3	✓	✓	✓
4 G3 + 1 G2		✓	✓
5 G2			✓
4 G1			✓



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Subject Criteria		
Subject	Subject Level in Sec 3	Criteria based on Sec 2 Overall Results
Chemistry and Physics	G3	Science G3 $\geq 70\%$
		Mathematics G3 $\geq 70\%$
Chemistry and Biology	G3	Science G3 $\geq 70\%$
		Mathematics G3 $\geq 70\%$
		English Lang G3 $\geq 65\%$
Pure Geography	G3	Geography G3 $\geq 65\%$
		English Lang G3 $\geq 65\%$
Literature in English	G3	Literature in Eng G3 $\geq 65\%$
		English Lang G3 $\geq 65\%$
Higher Mother Tongue	G3	Takes HMT at G3 or Mother Tongue G3 $\geq 80\%$
Additional Mathematics	G3	Mathematics G3 $\geq 50\%$
Additional Mathematics	G2	Mathematics G2 $\geq 75\%$ or failed Mathematics G3
Principles of Accounts	G2	Mathematics G2 $\geq 50\%$
		English Lang G2 $\geq 50\%$



Students taking mostly G3 subjects

S/N	G3 Pure Sciences (Phy/Chem)	G3 Pure Sciences (Bio/Chem)	G3 Pure Literature / Pure Geography		G3 Amaths + D&T			G3 (5 Subject Combi)
1	English Language	English Language	English Language		English Language			English Language
2	Mother Tongue Language / Higher Mother Tongue Language	Mother Tongue Language / Higher Mother Tongue Language	Mother Tongue Language / Higher Mother Tongue Language		Mother Tongue Language / Higher Mother Tongue Language			Mother Tongue Language / Higher Mother Tongue Language
3	Mathematics	Mathematics	Mathematics		Mathematics			Mathematics
4	Chemistry	Chemistry	Science (Chemistry/ Biology)		Science (Physics/Chemistry)			Science (Chemistry/ Biology) <u>or</u> Science (Physics/Chemistry)
5	Humanities (Social Studies + Geography)	Humanities (Social Studies + Geography)	Humanities (Social Studies + Geography) <u>or</u> (Social Studies + History)					Humanities (Social Studies + History)
6	Additional Mathematics	Additional Mathematics	Additional Mathematics		Additional Mathematics (G2/G3)	-	Additional Mathematics (G2/G3)	
7	Physics	Biology	Literature in English	Geography	Design & Technology	Design & Technology	-	

The subject combination may be subjected to changes.

Note: Student choosing 5 Subject Combi must not be taking G1 MTL or de-register any subjects in Sec 4.



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Students taking mostly G2 subjects

S/N	Subject (6 Subject Combi)				Subject (5 Subject Combi)
1	English Language				English Language
2	Mother Tongue Language / Higher Mother Tongue Language				Mother Tongue Language / Higher Mother Tongue Language
3	Mathematics				Mathematics
4	Science (Physics/Chemistry)	Science (Chemistry/ Biology)			Science (Chemistry/ Biology)
5	Humanities (Social Studies + History)	Humanities (Social Studies + Geography)			Humanities (Social Studies + Geography)
6	Principles of Accounts	Additional Mathematics	Nutrition and Food Science	Art	

Note: Student choosing 5 subjects must not de-register any subjects in Sec 4.

The subject combination may be subjected to changes.

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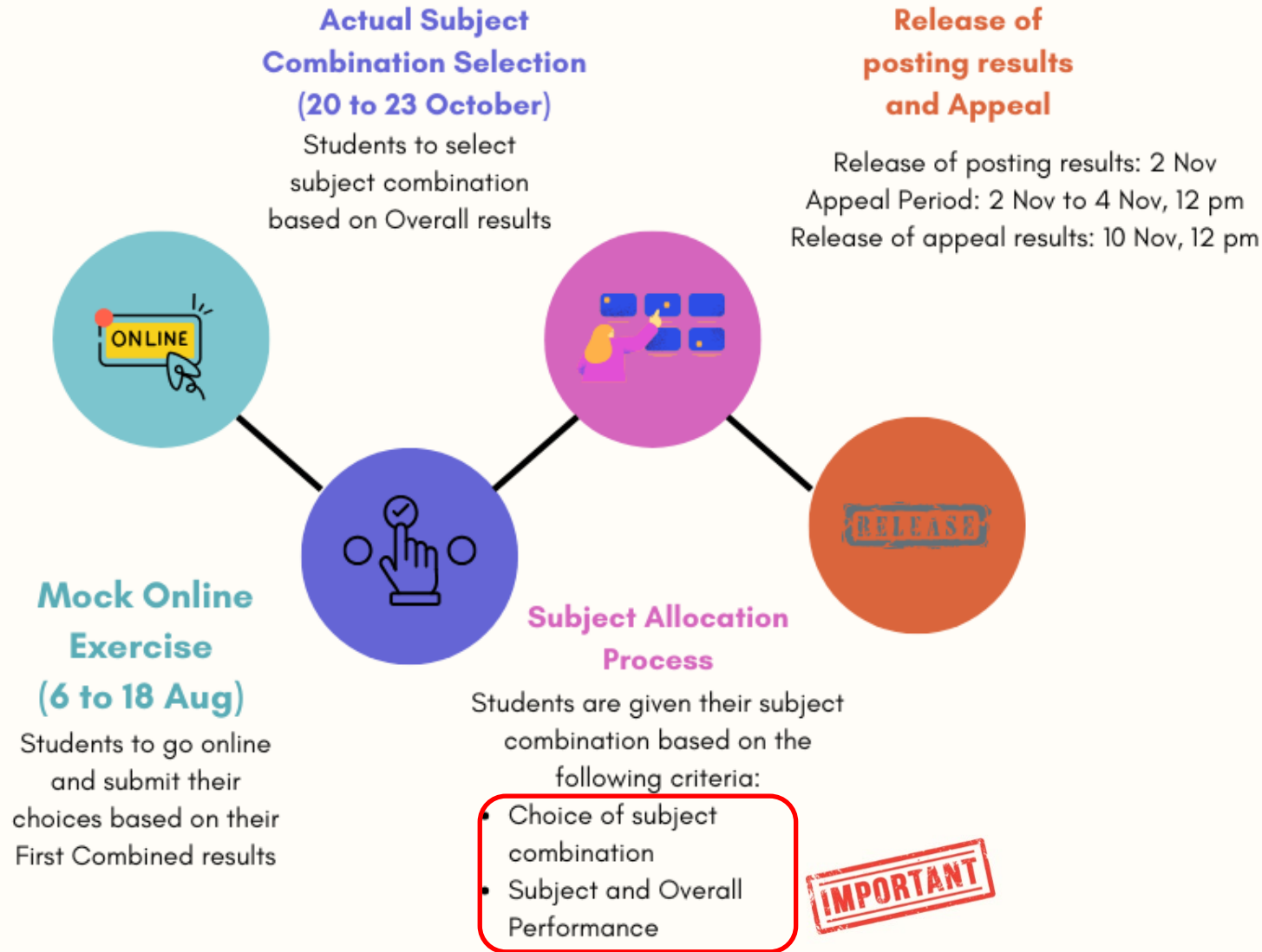


Students taking mostly G1 subjects

S/N	Subject	
1	English Language	
2	Mother Tongue Language	
3	Mathematics	
4	Computing	
5	Art	Science
6*	G1 Humanities (Non Examinable)	



Selection process and timeline for Sec 3 subject combination



Questions & Answer

- 1. How does the school allocate Subject Combinations to students?**
- 2. How can I determine which Subject Combination is most suitable for my child? Should the decision be based on their academic results, interests, or both?**
- 3. Could students change their Subject Combination later if they find it unsuitable?**
- 4. What happens if a student has difficulty coping with the subjects they have chosen? What options or help are available if they cannot cope?**
- 5. If a student fails multiple subjects, how should they choose their Subject Combination for Secondary 3?**



Changes in education landscape with FSBB

Students taking at least	POST-SEC PATHWAYS							
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5 G3 subjects	✓	✓	NEW ✓	✓	NEW ✓	✓	✓	NEW ✓
4 G3 + 1 G2 subjects	✓	✓	NEW ✓	NEW ✓	NEW ✓	NEW ✓		
5 G2 subjects	✓	✓	✓		✓			
4 G1 subjects	✓	NEW* ✓						



PSE Aggregate Scores Calculation: Bonus Points

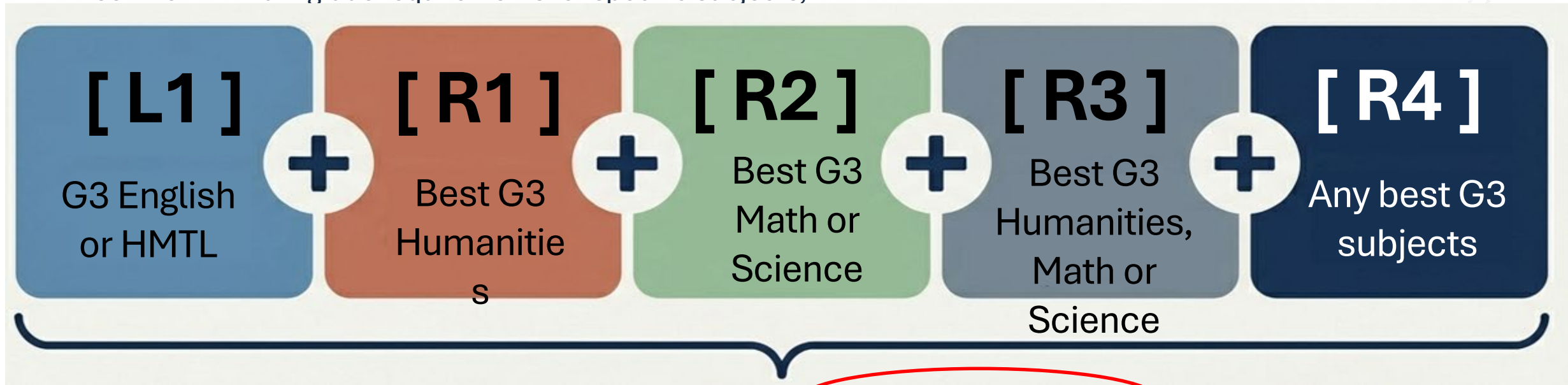
Type	Bonus Points	JC/MI	Polytechnic Diploma/ PFP/ ITE 2-Year and 3- Year Higher Nitec
CCA Grade	Excellent: 2	✓ Maximum 4 3 bonus points	✓ Not applicable
	Good: 1		
English and Higher Mother Tongue Language Grade A1 to C6 for both subjects	2		
Chinese (Special Programme) / Malay (Special Programme) or Bahasa Indonesia grade A1 to C6	2		
Affiliated JC	2		
Chinese/ Malay/ Tamil Language Elective Programme (CLEP/ MLEP/ TLEP)	2	✓ Additional bonus points if you apply and are selected for LEP	



Junior Colleges and Millennia Institute

Aggregate Type: L1R4

- ✓ All subjects used in aggregate score computation for JC and MI admissions must be **taken at G3**.
 - Mother Tongue Language (MTL) and Higher MTL (HMTL) cannot be used in the same aggregate computation
 - Religious Knowledge cannot be used.
- ✓ Meet the minimum grade requirements for specific subjects,



Gross Aggregate must be ≤ 16 for JC Admission

Gross Aggregate must be ≤ 20 for MI Admission



Example 1 : Junior College & Millennia Institute (JC/MI)

Student with 6 G3 subjects and not taking HMTL

Subjects & Grades

1. G3 English Language
2. G3 Humanities (SS + History)
3. G3 Mathematics
4. G3 Chemistry
5. G3 Malay Language
6. G3 Physics

A2

B3

A2

B3

A2

B4

CCA = EXCELLENT

Aggregate Type L1R4

[L1] EL or HMTL
2pts

[R1] Humanities
3pt

[R2] Math / Science
2pt

[R3] Humanities/
Math/ Science
3pts

[R4] Any best G3
subject
2pts

Malay Language (A2) is used, instead of Physics (B4).

Calculation

Gross L1R4 12 points

Bonus Points Deduction -2 points

Net Score 10 points

Using bonus points from CCA (2)

Checklist

JC Requirement:
Gross L1R4 ≤ 16 ✓
Subject to meeting subject requirement.

MI Requirement
Gross L1R4 ≤ 20 ✓
Subject to meeting subject requirement.

Example 2 : Junior College & Millennia Institute (JC/MI)

Student with 6 G3 subjects including HMTL

Subjects & Grades

1. G3 Higher Chinese Language

B3

2. G3 Humanities (SS + History)

A1

3. G3 Mathematics

A1

4. G3 Science (Physics/Chemistry)

B3

5. G3 English Language

C6

6. O Level Chinese Language

B3

CCA = EXCELLENT

Aggregate Type L1R4

[L1] EL or HMTL
3pts

[R1] Humanities
1pt

[R2] Math/ Science
1pt

[R3] Humanities/
Math/ Science
3pts

[R4] Any best G3
subject
6pts

O-Level Chinese cannot be used when Higher Chinese is used for computation.

Calculation

Gross L1R4 15 points

Bonus Points Deduction -3 points

Net Score 12 points

Using bonus points from HMT (2) and CCA (2), total = 2 + 2 = 4
Capped at 3 bonus points.

Checklist

JC Requirement
Gross L1R4 ≤ 16 ✓
Subject to meeting subject requirement.

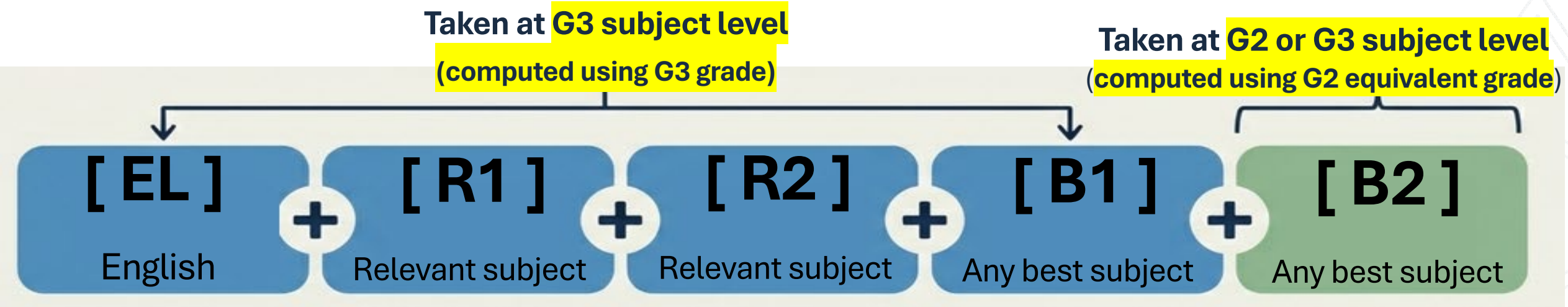
MI Requirement
Gross L1R4 ≤ 20 ✓
Subject to meeting subject requirement.

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Polytechnic Diploma - Aggregate Type: ELR2B2

- ✓ Four Aggregate Types: ELR2B2-A/B/C/D **NET** aggregate score must **not exceed 22 (or 24 for Nursing courses)**.
- ✓ Meet the Minimum Entry Requirement (MER) of the course that you are applying for.



NOTE :
G3 grade 9 and G2 grades 5 or 6
cannot be used
for ELR2B2 aggregate score computation.

Scenario: What if I use two G3 subjects for B1 and B2?

Better G3 Grade



To be used as [B1]

Other G3 Grade



Maps to G2
equivalent grade to
be used as [B2]



PSE Aggregate Score Calculation:

Downward Mapping of G3, G2, G1 Grades and ITE Aggregate Points

The legacy GCE O-Level, N(A)-Level, and N(T)-Level are now equivalent to G3, G2 and G1 respectively. Several pathways compute aggregate scores using equivalent grades (i.e. mapped grades).

O-Level/ G3	N(A)-Level/ G2	N(T)-Level/ G1	ITE Aggregate Points (For 3-Year <i>Higher Nitec</i> <i>computation</i>)
A1	1	A	1
A2			
B3			
B4	2		
C5			
C6			
D7	3		
E8	4	B	2
9	5	C	3
	6	D	4
		E	5



Invalid Grade Exception

For Polytechnic ELR2B2 and PFP ELMAB3:

- ✗ G3 grade 9 and G2 grades 5 & 6 cannot be used for computation.

For ITE 2-Year ELMAB3:

- ✗ G3 grade 9 and G2 grade 6 can be used for aggregate computation, but cannot fulfil subject-specific Minimum Entry Requirements (MER).

For ITE 3-Year R2B2/R1B3/B4 :

- ✗ G3 grade 9, G2 grade 6 and G1 Grade E can be used for aggregate computation, but cannot fulfil subject-specific Minimum Entry Requirements (MER).

Example 1 : Polytechnic Diploma

Student with 4 G3 and 1 G2 subjects

Subjects & Grades

1. G3 English Language

B3

2. G3 Mathematics

B4

3. G3 Humanities

C6

4. G3 Science
(Physics/Chemistry)

B4

5. G2 Chinese Language

1

CCA = EXCELLENT

Aggregate Type ELR2B2 - B

[EL]
3pts

[R1]
4pts

[R2]
6pts

[B1]
4pts

[B2]
1pt

G2

Calculation

Gross ELR2B2-B 18 points

CCA Points
Deduction -2 points

Net Score 16 points

Checklist

Poly Diploma
Requirement

Net ELR2B2 ≤ 22

Subject to meeting MER of the
courses



Example 2 : Polytechnic Diploma

Student with 5 G3 subjects

Subjects & Grades

1. G3 English Language

A1

2. G3 Mathematics

B3

3. G3 Humanities

C6

4. G3 Science
(Physics/Chemistry)

A2

5. G3 Tamil Language

B3

CCA = EXCELLENT

G2 Map

1

Aggregate Type ELR2B2 - B

[EL]
1pt

[R1]
3pts

[R2]
6pts

[B1]
2pts

[B2]
1pt

Calculation

Gross ELR2B2-B 13 points

CCA Points
Deduction -2 points

Net Score 11 points

Checklist

Poly Diploma
Requirement
Net ELR2B2 ≤ 22



Subject to meeting MER of the
courses



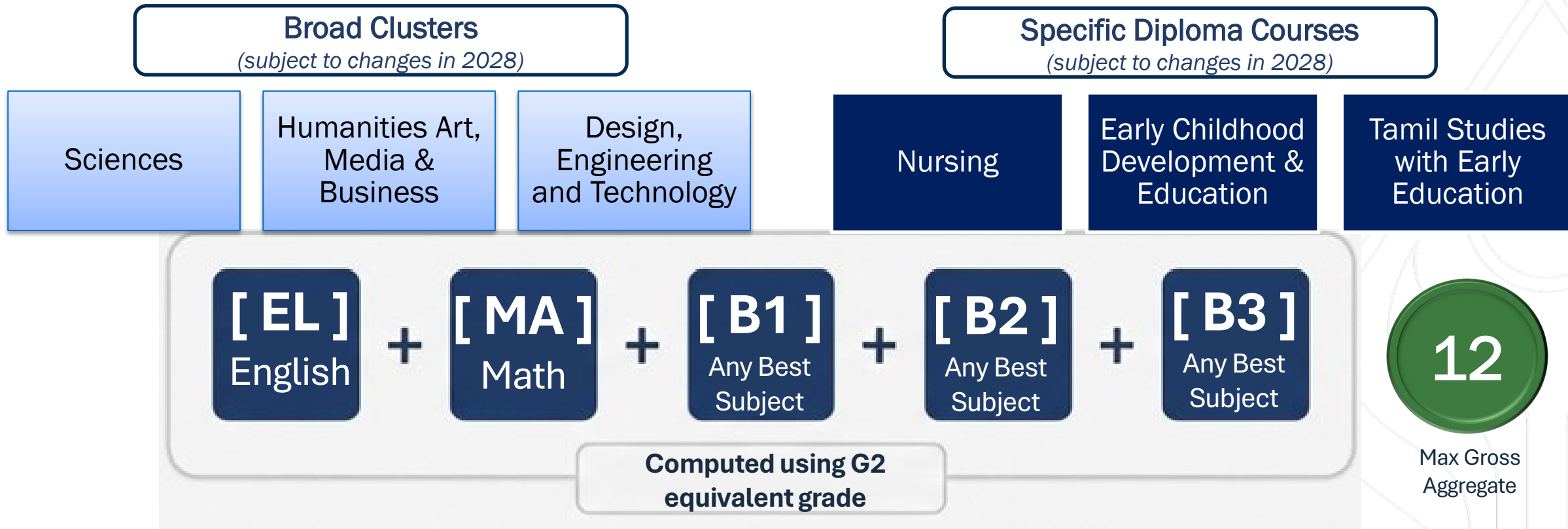
Polytechnic Foundation Programme (PFP)

Aggregate Type: ELMAB3



1 Year Prep route

- ✓ ELMAB3 **GROSS** aggregate score uses exclusively **G2 equivalent grades** and must not exceed 12.
- ✓ Meet the Minimum Entry Requirement (MER) of the cluster/courses that you are applying for.



Example 1 : Polytechnic Foundation Programme (PFP)

Student with 4 G3 and 1 G2 subjects

Subjects & Grades

1. G3 English Language

B4

2. G3 Mathematics

C5

3. G3 Humanities

D7

4. G3 Science
(Physics/Chemistry)

B4

5. G2 Chinese Language

1

CCA = GOOD

G2 Map

2

[EL]

2pts

G2 Map

2

[MA]

2pts

G2 Map

3

[B1]

3pts

G2 Map

2

[B2]

2pts

[B3]

1pt

Aggregate Type ELMAB3

Calculation

Gross ELMAB3 10 points

CCA Points
Deduction -1 point

Net Score 9 points

Checklist

PFP Requirement

Gross ELMAB3 $\leq$ 12 ✓

Subject to meeting MER of the
clusters/ courses.

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Subject Criteria		
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		Mathematics G3 $\geq 70\%$
Chemistry and Biology	G3	Science G3 $\geq 70\%$
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		English Lang G3 $\geq 65\%$
Pure Geography	G3	Geography G3 $\geq 65\%$
		English Lang G3 $\geq 65\%$
Literature in English	G3	Literature in Eng G3 $\geq 65\%$
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Higher Mother Tongue	G3	Takes HMT at G3 or Mother Tongue G3 $\geq 80\%$
Additional Mathematics	G3	Mathematics G3 $\geq 50\%$
Additional Mathematics	G2	Mathematics G2 $\geq 75\%$ or failed Mathematics G3
Principles of Accounts	G2	Mathematics G2 $\geq 50\%$
		English Lang G2 $\geq 50\%$



Students taking mostly G3 subjects

S/N	G3 Pure Sciences (Phy/Chem)	G3 Pure Sciences (Bio/Chem)	G3 Pure Literature / Pure Geography		G3 Amaths + D&T			G3 (5 Subject Combi)
1	English Language	English Language	English Language		English Language			English Language
2	Mother Tongue Language / Higher Mother Tongue Language	Mother Tongue Language / Higher Mother Tongue Language	Mother Tongue Language / Higher Mother Tongue Language		Mother Tongue Language / Higher Mother Tongue Language			Mother Tongue Language / Higher Mother Tongue Language
3	Mathematics	Mathematics	Mathematics		Mathematics			Mathematics
4	Chemistry	Chemistry	Science (Chemistry/ Biology)		Science (Physics/Chemistry)			Science (Chemistry/ Biology) <u>or</u> Science (Physics/Chemistry)
5	Humanities (Social Studies + Geography)	Humanities (Social Studies + Geography)	Humanities (Social Studies + Geography) <u>or</u> (Social Studies + History)					Humanities (Social Studies + History)
6	Additional Mathematics	Additional Mathematics	Additional Mathematics		Additional Mathematics (G2/G3)	-	Additional Mathematics (G2/G3)	
7	Physics	Biology	Literature in English	Geography	Design & Technology	Design & Technology	-	

The subject combination may be subjected to changes.

Note: Student choosing 5 Subject Combi must not be taking G1 MTL or de-register any subjects in Sec 4.



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G3 Group (Q&A)



Questions & Answer for G3

1. Could G3 students choose not to take Additional Mathematics?
2. Under the new Singapore-Cambridge Secondary Education Certificate (SEC), is it necessary to pass both Elementary Mathematics and Additional Mathematics to progress to the next educational pathway?
3. If a student is taking G3 Mathematics but is not strong in the subject and chooses Additional Mathematics, will the Additional Mathematics be offered at the G2 level?
4. Which Subject Combination provides the most options for Polytechnic admission? Could you advise on the pathways for students taking CLB who are interested in healthcare?
5. Could you advise on the pathways for students taking CLB who are interested in healthcare?



Supporting Your Child's ECG Journey Considerations & Resources



When deciding how many and what subjects your child wants to take, do consider the following:

- In which subjects do you find yourself **grasping concepts quickly** without needing extensive additional support?
- Which subject areas do you find yourself **demonstrating the most resilience** in when working on **challenging academic tasks**?

- How do you typically **manage your current study workload and time**?
- How much **time do you need** for rest, family, other commitments and social activities to **maintain good mental health**?

Strengths

Interests

Curriculum Load

1. How many subjects should I take?
2. What subjects should I take?

Well-being

Aspirations

- Which **subjects** are you **interested** in?
- Outside of academics, what **personal interests** do/ would you like to pursue?

- Which **post-secondary pathway** are you aspiring to?
- Which **course** in a particular pathway do you hope to pursue?



Resources

Video – Heart to Heart Talk



<https://go.gov.sg/h2htep2>

ECG Tips for Parents



<https://go.gov.sg/tips-for-parents>



Need someone to talk to
about your Child's
Education and Career journey?

Ms Teoh, ECG Counsellor
Tuesday & Thursday | TS 5
8.30am – 5pm

To book an appointment:
<https://go.gov.sg/ecgcmsteoh>

Email: teoh_fan_yun@schools.gov.sg



<https://go.gov.sg/ecgcmsteoh>



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